

IELTS Academic Preparation

Every workbook exercise and self-check answered, with notes on acceptable alternatives and common learner errors. Confidential teacher material.

4 modules

Exercise & quiz answers

Confidential – do not distribute

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Module 1 — The Test & Foundations: Answers

Answers to every Module 1 workbook exercise and self-check question, with the "why," acceptable alternatives, model versions for the open tasks (the study plan, paraphrases, the grammar upgrade), notes on the C1 welcome pages, and the errors you can expect to meet most. The diagnostic's own key and the raw-score → band tables are in

[assessment/answer-keys.html](#).

Lessons 1.1-1.3 + C1

Classes C1-C4

9 self-check items

15 exercises

MARKING PRINCIPLE

These are exam-preparation answers, so mark the way IELTS marks **closed** items and the way a helpful teacher marks **open** ones. **Closed items** (Listening and Reading style: Exercise 5 in 1.1, Exercises 1 and 4 in 1.2, Exercise 3 in 1.3): a correct answer must be spelled correctly and must respect the word limit. British and American spellings are both accepted (*center* / *centre*), and so are numbers written as figures or words (*5 p.m.* / *five p.m.*). **Open items** (paraphrases, combined sentences, the upgrade): the models below are *examples*. Accept any version that keeps the meaning exactly (including quantities and hedges such as *most*, *some*, *may*), is grammatically accurate, and uses the target structure or technique. When a learner's version is correct but misses the target, accept it and point to the target: "Good. Can you also do it with a relative clause?" American English is the model.

C1 · WELCOME PAGES (ORIENTATION)

◆ COURSE CONTRACT, MY TARGET, BAND TRACKER

No answers: these belong to the learner. Check only that (1) the **My target** card has an overall band *and* a per-skill minimum (or "not sure yet": the C1 homework is to find out), (2) the test date has a week count, and (3) the band tracker is filled in privately after C2 (L and R) and C4 (W, S and error density). Expect decimal commas ("6,5") on the target card: accept them in C1, teach "six point five" in C2. If a learner's target is far above their diagnostic estimate and the test is soon, talk to them privately (see the Teacher's Guide, "High stakes, kindly").

1.1 · IELTS OVERVIEW — FORMAT, BANDS & STRATEGY (C2)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – THE RESULTS CONVERSATION (SCRIPT 1.1-A)

Listening	Reading	Writing	Speaking	Average	Overall
7.0	6.0	5.5	6.5	6.25	6.5

Requirement: overall **6.5**, no band below **6.0**. Priority: **Writing** (5.5 is below the minimum, even though the overall is reached). The traps in the script: Amal first remembers Reading as 6.5 (the adviser corrects it to 6.0), and the adviser mentions a friend's 7.0 overall. Accept "seven," "7," "six and a half."

◆ EXERCISE 2 – THE TEST MAP (INFORMATION GAP)

Section	Time	Parts / questions	What you do	One warning
Listening	about 30 min	4 recordings · 40 questions	listen to conversations and talks; answer as you listen	you hear each recording once · spelling counts
Reading	60 min	3 passages · 40 questions	read long academic texts; many question types	no extra transfer time · about 20 min per passage
Writing	60 min	2 tasks	Task 1: describe visual data or a process (150+ words) · Task 2: an essay (250+ words)	Task 2 counts twice as much · too few words lose marks
Speaking	11–14 min	3 parts	interview · long turn from a cue card · discussion	a real examiner · don't memorize answers

Any accurate "warning" is fine. Accept "2 hours 45 minutes" for the whole test.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – BAND MATHS

Profile	Sum	Average	Overall
1 (6.0 · 6.0 · 5.5 · 6.0)	23.5	5.875	6.0
2 (7.5 · 7.0 · 6.0 · 6.5)	27	6.75	7.0 (.75 rounds up to the next whole band)
3 (6.5 · 7.0 · 6.0 · 6.0)	25.5	6.375	6.5
4 (5.5 · 6.0 · 6.0 · 6.5)	24	6.0	6.0

Profile 3 and "overall 6.5, no band below 6.5": **No**. The overall is reached, but **Writing and Speaking** (6.0) are below the minimum. **Common errors**: rounding 6.75 down to 6.5, rounding 5.875 down to 5.5, and forgetting the per-skill minimum.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – MYTH OR FACT?

- 1 **M**. There is no pass or fail; you get a band for each skill and an overall band. Institutions set their own requirements.
- 2 **M**. There is no penalty for a wrong answer, so never leave a blank.
- 3 **F**. A misspelled answer is marked wrong. British and American spellings are both accepted.

- 4 M. Same content, same scoring. Choose the format you're more comfortable with and practice in it.
- 5 F. Task 2 carries twice the weight of Task 1.
- 6 F. An answer under the minimum length loses marks for task achievement / task response.
- 7 M. Examiners assess how easy you are to understand, not a particular accent. A clear accent from any country is fine.
- 8 M. Examiners are trained to notice rehearsed answers, and a memorized script doesn't show what you can do. Prepare ideas and phrases, not scripts.
- 9 M. Vocabulary is rewarded for being precise and natural. A rare word used wrongly costs more than a plain word used well.
- 10 M. Any clear, well-supported position can score well. The examiner marks how you argue, not what you believe.
- 11 F. (.25 rounds up to .5; .75 rounds up to the next whole band.)
- 12 F. A hyphenated word counts as one word in completion answers.

If learners ask about details that vary by test center or change over time (what you can bring, retake options, how results are sent), don't guess: point them to the official IELTS website or their test center.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – THE WORD-LIMIT DRILL (TIMED)

- 1 **main library** ("the main library" = 3 words = wrong)
- 2 **5 p.m.** (also *5 pm*, *5:00*, *five p.m.*, *5 o'clock*) ("at 5 p.m." is acceptable as a word + number; "9 p.m." = the Monday–Thursday time = wrong)
- 3 **information desk** ("the information desk" = wrong)
- 4 **student card** ("valid student card" repeats the given word and makes three = wrong)
- 5 **closed bottles** (also *bottles*)

The point of the drill: nearly every item has a correct three-word version that scores zero. **Common errors:** adding *the*, copying a word already printed in the note ("valid"), *library*, *infomation*.

◆ DIALOGUE – PLANNING FROM THE GAP

Target: *overall six point five*. Per-skill minimum: *no band below six*. Priority: *Writing* (about 5.5, below the minimum). Mei's advice is good because the minimum can't be met by a strong Reading score; she keeps some Reading practice, so Tariq doesn't lose his strength; and Tariq's expectation (half a band in ten weeks, a full band "a bonus") is realistic.

◆ MY IELTS PLAN AND THE STUDY-PLAN INTERVIEW (MODEL)

Model (New identity card 2, Joon): Target overall 7.0, no skill below 6.5 · test date in 10 weeks · diagnostic $\approx$ 6.0 · gap: 1.0 overall, Writing and Speaking below the minimum · skills: Reading, Listening, Speaking, Writing · priority:

Writing, because it is furthest below the minimum and Task 2 counts double · weekly: two Task 2 essays (40 min each, timed), one Task 1, one timed Reading passage, 15 minutes of speaking practice four times a week · if a week goes wrong: one essay and one Reading passage, minimum. **Check:** every plan has a number in the weekly commitment and puts the weakest skill (or the one below the minimum) first. A plan that promises three hours a day on top of a full-time job is not realistic: gently suggest something they can keep up for eight weeks.

◆ SELF - CHECK

Q1

"NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS." You write a correct three-word answer. Score?

A) Full marks

B) Half a mark

C) Zero

Why: the word limit is part of the instruction. There are no half marks; breaking the limit makes the answer wrong.

Q2

L 6.0, R 6.5, W 6.0, S 7.0. Overall?

A) 6.5

B) 6.0

C) 7.0

Why: $25.5 \div 4 = 6.375$, which is nearer 6.5 than 6.0.

Q3 · new

Which statement about IELTS Writing is true?

A) Equal weight, 30 minutes each.

B) Task 2 carries more weight, so give it about 40 minutes.

C) Excellent grammar lets you write fewer words.

Why: Task 2 counts twice as much as Task 1, so the usual split is about 20 + 40 minutes. Writing under the minimum length loses marks however good the grammar is.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (1.1)

"six comma five" / "6,5" · "I passed IELTS with 6" · "rise my score" (*raise*) · "the Listening have 40 questions" · *thirteen* / *thirty* mixed up in Script 1.1-B · rounding .75 down · forgetting the per-skill minimum · extra *the* in completion answers · plans with no numbers ("study more"). For range, praise precise test vocabulary used naturally: *a per-skill minimum, my weakest skill, I'll prioritize Writing because...*

1.2 · ACADEMIC VOCABULARY & PARAPHRASING (C3)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – THE WORKSHOP REGISTRATION (SCRIPT 1.2-A)

1 Day	2 Start time	3 Place	4 Bring	5 Student fee	6 Family name
Thursday	4:30 (p.m.) · half past four	Room 12	(a) laptop	\$15 · 15 dollars	Okafor

The traps: 1 Tuesday is mentioned first, but "that session won't be going ahead" · 2 "it used to start at four" · 3 "Room 21... no, sorry, Room 12" · 4 "you don't need a notebook... we'll give you paper" · 5 \$20 is the full price; students pay \$15 · 6 the student spells it; *Okafor* must be spelled exactly (capital letter not required). Accept *Thurs.*; don't accept *Room 21, notebook, \$20, Okafur*.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – WORD FAMILIES

Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
analyze	analysis	analytical	analytically
benefit	benefit	beneficial	beneficially
vary	variation / variety	various / variable	—
signify	significance	significant	significantly
sustain	sustainability	sustainable	sustainably

- 1 analysis
- 2 beneficial
- 3 variation (*variety* is possible but less precise here)
- 4 significantly
- 5 economical (cheap to run; *economic* = about the economy)
- 6 sustainable

Item 5 tests the *economic* / *economical* pair from the grammar box. **Wrong:** "the analyze," "analyst," "beneficial," "significant rose," "sustainability transport."

◆ EXERCISE 3 – CLIMB THE LADDER (MODELS; WORDING MAY VARY)

- 1 The construction of more bike lanes led to a fall in the number of people driving to work. / After more bike lanes were built, fewer residents commuted by car.
- 2 Children's screen time is a source of concern for many parents. / A considerable number of parents are concerned about the amount of time children spend online.
- 3 Air quality was measured in twelve cities (by scientists).
- 4 Fruit is less expensive at the market. / Fruit can be bought more cheaply at the market.
- 5 a) The majority of students prefer to study in the evening. · b) Evening study is preferred by most students. · c) For most students, the evening is the best time to study. (Any version that says "most" or "the majority"; **not** "students," "many students" or "all students".)

Check each version for **meaning drift**: item 1 must keep both facts (more lanes, fewer drivers) and the link between them; item 2 must keep "many"; item 4 must keep "cheaper" (not "cheap"). Item 3: "Twelve cities' air was measured" is correct but awkward; accept it and offer the model.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – GARDENS ON THE ROOF (TIMED)

1	2	3	4	5	6
C	A	D	B	B	C

- 1 C: "far less during the heaviest storms" = reduced in extreme weather.
- 2 A: "Critics point out that the initial cost is high" = a reason some people are against them.
- 3 D: "a single type of low-growing plant offers little food... a mix of native flowering species attract a wider variety" = the choice of plants affects the result.
- 4 B: "two to three times as much as a conventional one" = considerably more expensive. A is a trap (*fifteen years* is from a different sentence); C twists *three times*.
- 5 B: "the best documented benefit" = supported by more evidence. A contradicts "the effect on lower floors is small"; C is a trap on the word *air* (the text says water evaporating carries heat away).
- 6 C: "retained roughly half of the rain... over a year." A is the opposite (far less in the heaviest storms); B is the opposite (releasing it slowly).

The passage and questions are original. Scores of 4–6 in 8 minutes are good for this point in the course; a learner who scores 2–3 because they ran out of time needs the Module 2 skimming work more than vocabulary.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – UPGRADE WITH THE RIGHT PARTNER

- 1 detrimental

- 2 substantial
- 3 acquire (*obtain skills* is understandable but less natural; *develop* and *gain* are also good)
- 4 give rise to
- 5 illustrates
- 6 considerable
- 7 Traffic noise has a detrimental / an adverse effect on people's sleep.
- 8 Video calls facilitate communication between people who work in different countries.

Not yet: "Traffic noise is detrimental for sleep" (the preposition is *to*: *detrimental to*) · "Video calls facilitate people to communicate" (*facilitate* takes a noun object, not a person + to-infinitive).

◆ DIALOGUE – CHECKING A PARAPHRASE

Drift errors in Ana's first version: *Everybody* (the prompt says *some people*) and *must* (the prompt says *should*). Also "cost nothing" is fine in meaning. Ben's version climbs **rung 1** (synonyms: *university courses* → *higher education*, *free* → *free of charge*, *should* → *ought to*) and **rung 4** (structure: *Some people think...* → *It is sometimes argued that...*), and arguably rung 5 (*university courses* → *higher education* is a more general term).

◆ PARAPHRASE RELAY (MODELS FOR THE PROMPT CARDS)

Card 1 (cycle lanes): "It is sometimes argued that urban roads ought to devote more room to cyclists, even at the expense of drivers." Card 3 (online degrees): "There is some debate about whether a qualification earned entirely over the internet is worth as much as one from a traditional campus." Card 5 (museum fees): "Many people believe that there should be no admission charge for publicly funded galleries and exhibitions." Models for all eight cards are printed small on each card (classroom materials, set E). Accept any version that keeps the scope ("some," "all," "should") and avoids the three "don't repeat" words.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

A question says "the factory increased its output." Which sentence is the paraphrased answer?

A) "The factory scaled back what it produced."

B) "The plant's production rose over the period."

C) "The manager increased his output of emails."

Why: *plant* = factory, *production* = output, *rose* = increased. A says the opposite; C is a trap that repeats *increased* and *output* with a different meaning.

Q2

Best academic upgrade of "Technology helps people communicate"?

A) Technology assists to communicate people.

B) Technology facilitates communication.

C) Technology aids the communicating of people.

Why: *facilitate* + noun is a natural collocation, and *communicate* → *communication* changes the word class. A and C are ungrammatical.

Q3 · new

"The number of visitors doubled." Which sentence matches?

A) "Visitor numbers rose considerably."

B) "Twice as many people visited as in the previous year."

C) "The visitors doubled their spending."

Why: *twice as many* = doubled. A is too general (a rise, not necessarily double); C shares the word *doubled* but is about spending, not numbers: a classic synonym trap.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (1.2)

One-word paraphrases · meaning drift with quantities and modals (*some* → *all*, *should* → *must*, *may* → *will*) · wrong member of the family ("the economy growth," "an analyze," "very benefit") · *economic/economical* · collocation errors with upgrades ("do a research," "a substantial adolescent," "detrimental for") · false friends (*actual* = current, *eventual* = possible, *assist* = attend) · choosing an answer because one word matches · stress on *ANalysis*, *ecoNOmy*. For range, praise accurate chunks: *give rise to*, *a considerable proportion of*, *it is sometimes argued that*.

1.3 · GRAMMAR FOR A HIGH BAND (C4)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – THREE ANSWERS (SCRIPT 1.3-A)

	Candidate A	Candidate B	Candidate C
subordinate clause	—	✓ (although, because)	✓ (because, since)
relative clause	—	✓ (which, who)	✓ (which)
conditional	—	✓ (but wrong form)	✓ (second conditional)

comparative	(more jobs)	(more jobs)	✓ (far higher... than)
errors that blur the meaning?	no	yes	no

C shows range with control. A is accurate but uses only simple sentences (range around band 5). B is ambitious, but the errors pile up: "Although..., but," "which make many people to think twice," "If people will not find... they would go back," "the number of families who moves... are," "because of they want." Accept "C" with any reasonable reason.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – COMBINE INTO ONE SENTENCE (MODELS)

- 1 Although public libraries are free, many people do not use them. / Many people do not use public libraries, although they are free.
- 2 Employees who work from home often save time.
- 3 The museum, which is in the city center, attracts two million visitors a year.
- 4 If fees were lower, more students would enroll.
- 5 Having doubled in a decade, car sales then fell sharply.

Wrong: "Although..., but..." (1) · "Some employees who work from home, they often save time" (2: extra subject) · "The museum which is in the city center attracts..." (3: this makes it defining, as if there were several museums; accept it only if the learner can explain that) · "If fees would be lower" / "If fees are lower, more students will enroll" (4: the second is correct grammar but a first conditional; accept it and ask for the second) · "Having doubled in a decade, the sales of cars fell then" or a dangling subject such as "Having doubled, the market saw a fall" (5).

◆ EXERCISE 3 – TENSE BY TASK

- 1 doubled (past simple: the period has ended)
- 2 have risen (present perfect: up to now; accept *have been rising*)
- 3 is expected to reach (a forecast; accept *is projected / predicted to reach, will reach*)
- 4 is heated (present simple passive: a process)
- 5 had ... would eat (second conditional; accept *had ... would probably eat*)

◆ EXERCISE 4 – ERROR HUNT AND ERROR DENSITY

Error-free: sentence 1 only → **1 out of 8** (not "most": accuracy is the priority for this writer).

Sentence	Error(s)	Correction	Type
2	have grown	has grown	agreement (<i>the number... has</i>)
3	This give	This gives	agreement

4	effect	affect	word form
5	advices	advice	uncountable
6	informations · comma splice	information · "...online meetings, so that students can ask questions." / "...meetings. Students can then ask questions."	uncountable · run-on
7	an increase of	an increase in	preposition
8	will continue · university	continues · universities (or <i>the university</i> / <i>a university</i>)	conditional · article / number

Corrected paragraph: Nowadays, many students study from home for part of the week. The number of online courses has grown quickly in recent years. This gives students more flexibility, especially those who work. However, studying alone can affect motivation. Some learners say they need more advice and feedback from teachers. Universities should provide clear information and regular online meetings, so that students can ask questions. In addition, there is an increase in demand for quiet study spaces at libraries. If this trend continues, universities should plan for mixed teaching.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – THE GRAMMAR UPGRADE (MODEL; MANY VERSIONS ARE POSSIBLE)

Model: "Since our neighborhood library opened a quiet study room last year, it has become far more popular with students, many of whom use the free internet there. Having seen visitor numbers rise, the library now wants to open the room on Sundays as well." **Structures:** subordinate clause (*since*) · comparative (*far more popular*) · non-defining relative (*many of whom*) · participle clause (*having seen*). Simpler model: "The library, which opened a quiet study room last year, now has more visitors because many students use the room, where they get free internet. If the room opened on Sundays too, even more people would visit." (Careful: that last sentence adds a prediction; accept it as a hypothetical, but point out that it is a new idea.)

Check with the tick-boxes: 4+ *different* structures, no new errors, same facts, no monster sentences. **Watch for:** "Although the room is quiet, but..." · "which students get free internet" (needs *where* or *in which*) · "Having opened the room, more people visit" (dangling participle: the people didn't open it) · "many of them use" after a comma (comma splice) instead of "many of whom."

◆ DIALOGUE – RANGE OR ACCURACY FIRST?

Second conditional: "If most of your sentences **were** error-free, your grammar band **would** probably go up." Relative clause: "Keep the ones (that) you can control" (a defining relative clause with the pronoun left out). Leo needs **accuracy** (3 of 9 sentences error-free; articles and "Although..., but"). Sara needs **range** (almost no errors, but one structure on repeat).

◆ PART 3 FRAMES AND THE ERROR LOG

No fixed answers. For the frames task, accept any answer that uses both frames on the card accurately; the observer's "errors that blurred meaning" column should list only real breakdowns, not every slip. For the error log, check that each fix is written **in the learner's own words** and that the "correct sentence" really is correct: this is where learners most often copy the error again.

Q1

Which sentence is fully correct?

A) The number of tourists is increasing, causing an increase in demand for information.

B) The number of tourists are increasing every year.

C) The number of tourists is increasing, causing an increase of informations.

Why: *the number of... is* (singular), *an increase in, information* (uncountable). B breaks agreement; C has the wrong preposition and a plural uncountable.

Q2

Which upgrade of "Prices rose. People bought less." is ranged and accurate?

A) Prices rose, people bought less.

B) Because of prices was rising, so people were buying less of things.

C) As prices rose, people bought less.

Why: a subordinate clause with *as*, correctly formed. A is a comma splice; B has *because of* + a clause, a double connector (*because... so*) and *less of things*.

Q3 · new

Which sentence is correct?

A) Although the course was short, but it was useful.

B) Although the course was short, it was useful.

C) The course was short, it was useful.

Why: one clause, one connector: *although* already shows the contrast. A doubles the connector (very common for speakers of Chinese, Vietnamese, Korean and Japanese); C is a comma splice.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (1.3)

"Although..., but..." and "Because..., so..." · missing or extra articles ("Government should build hospital," "The pollution is...") · "the number of X are" · "If it will..." · comma splices · "informations, advices, researches" · *affect* / *effect* · "an increase of" · past charts described in the present · dangling participle clauses · non-defining clauses with *that* ("The bridge, that opened in 1932, ..."). For range, praise accurate, well-placed structures, and praise the learner who *simplified* a sentence they couldn't control.

Module 2 — Listening & Reading: Answers

Answers to every Module 2 workbook exercise and self-check question, with the evidence (where each answer is heard or found, and the distractor or trap beside it), acceptable alternatives, and the errors you can expect to meet most. Practice Test 1 answers and the raw-score → band table are in [assessment/answer-keys.html](#).

Lessons 2.1-2.3 + PT1

Classes C5-C8

9 self-check items

15 exercises

MARKING PRINCIPLE

Mark Listening and Reading answers **the way the real test does**: one mark or zero, no half marks. An answer is correct only if it is (1) the right information, (2) **spelled correctly** (British or American spelling both accepted: *color / colour, center / centre*), (3) in the right **form** (plural if the answer is plural), and (4) **within the word limit**. Capital letters, lowercase, or a mix are all fine. Numbers may be written as figures or words, but figures are safer and shorter. Dates are accepted in any clear form (*19 March, March 19, 19th March*); an all-number date such as *19/3* is risky and best avoided in class. In Reading, words must be copied from the passage where the instructions say "from the passage." For **True / False / Not Given**, accept *T / F / NG* in class practice, but tell learners to check what the real answer sheet allows and to use the exact label the instructions give (never "Yes" on a True / False task). Be strict in marking and kind in talking about it: every lost mark is a code on the tally, and every code is fixable.

2.1 • IELTS LISTENING — STRATEGIES & QUESTION TYPES (C5)

◆ EXERCISE 1 — LETTERS AND NUMBERS (SCRIPT 2.1-A)

1	OKAFOR	6	0799 450 218 (spaces optional)
2	16 (the correction: "sixty — sorry, sixteen")	7	WHITFIELD
3	JG415 (G and J: listen for /dʒeɪ/ = J first)	8	240,000 (two hundred and forty thousand)
4	MALLORY ("double L")	9	50 (the correction: "fifteen — no, fifty")
5	4 August / August 4	10	BV7330 ("double three")

Traps: 2 and 9 (corrections), 3 (G/J), 8 (large number), 10 (B/V, "double"). **Expect:** *Okafer, Malory, Withfield, GJ415, 24,000 or 2,400,000, 73330, fourth August* (fine as a date, but *4 August* is cleaner).

◆ EXERCISE 2 — THE PART 1 FORM (SCRIPT 2.1-B)

Q	Answer	Predicted type	Trap
1	photography	noun (a subject)	distractor: "I was going to do pottery, but I think it's full"
2	Ferreira / FERREIRA	name (spelled)	"double R"; E / I letter names
3	82	number	-ty: <i>EIGHTy-two</i>
4	07700 900482	number	"oh," "double-oh," groups
5	Wednesday / Wednesdays	day	distractor: "most of our evening courses run on Mondays"
6	19 March / March 19 / 19th March	date	correction: "the twelfth of March — oh, no, sorry, that's the pottery group"
7	70	number (price)	distractor: "the full fee is eighty-five"; \$ already printed
8	40	number	correction + -teen/-ty: "fourteen — actually, sorry... forty"
9	batteries	plural noun	plural: <i>battery</i> = wrong
10	back	noun / place word	distractor: "don't use the lot at the front"

Do not accept: 1 *photograpy, fotography* · 2 *Ferrera, Fereira* · 5 *Wensday* · 7 \$70 is fine only if the learner wrote it and it stays within the limit; 85 or 15 = wrong · 9 *battery, spare batteries* (*spare* is already printed: "spare batteries" makes the sentence "spare spare batteries," so mark it wrong and discuss why) · 10 *behind* (the gap needs a noun: "at the ____ of the building"). Words that are fine: *the back* (two words, within the limit).

◆ EXERCISE 3 – LABEL THE PLAN (SCRIPT 2.1-C)

11 café	12 computer room	13 first-aid room	14 quiet study area	15 printing center	16 lost and found
B	F	D	G	C	H

Unused: A (the bookshop) and E (the seminar room), both mentioned but not asked about. **Traps:** 13, D "used to be where the lockers were" (the lockers moved upstairs); 11, "some people think the café is the room with the big windows at the front, but that's the bookshop" (A); 12, the computer room is "beyond" the seminar room, in the far right corner (F), not opposite the café (E). Learners who label from the *wrong starting point* usually swap left and right throughout (A↔D, B↔E, C↔F): that is an L or orientation error, not a listening one.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – PARTS 3 AND 4 (SCRIPTS 2.1-D AND 2.1-E)

Q	Answer	Evidence and distractors
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21	B	"we've gone for something broader: how students actually get to campus." A: rejected ("there's already a big report on that"). C: "That'll come up as one question, but it's not the main focus."
22	B	"The problem is that people ignore online surveys ... got about thirty replies." A: contradicted ("It's easy to set up, actually"). C: never said.
23	B	"for a project of this length, that's about right." A and C: "Much fewer and I'd worry; much more and you won't have time" (the tutor is describing what would be wrong, not their plan).
24	C	Aisha: "I'll email them today" (the transport office). A: Leo has "already started on those." B: "The room can wait until next month."
31	roofs	"roads, of course, but above all roofs." <i>roads</i> is in the notes already. Do not accept <i>roof</i> .
32	moisture	"they release moisture through their leaves." Do not accept <i>water</i> (not the word in the recording) or <i>water vapor</i> (two words, over the limit).
33	traffic	"People often blame air-conditioning units first ... the bigger source was traffic." <i>air conditioning</i> is already in the notes (the distractor).
34	white	"we painted the roofs ... white — we considered a light gray, which is cheaper, but it reflected far less sunlight." <i>gray</i> = distractor.
35	3 / three	"We'd hoped ... five degrees. In fact, the average drop was three." 5 = distractor; 7 (the heat-island gap) = an earlier number.

Paraphrase pairs for the stretch task: 21 *topic chosen* = "gone for"; 22 *too few people would reply* = "people ignore online surveys"; 23 *about right* = "about right" (a rare exact match: the paraphrase is in the distractors instead); 31 *dark surfaces* = "dark materials"; 33 *waste heat* = "what we call waste heat"; 35 *fell by* = "the average drop was."

◆ EXERCISE 5 – SPOT THE CORRECTION

- 1 10:30 / half past ten (the correction "sorry")
- 2 25 / twenty-five ("Actually, make that...")
- 3 Station Road ("Well, it was, until...")
- 4 (the) main hall ("not the library as it says in the leaflet")
- 5 eight weeks / 8 weeks: a trick. The course *lasts* eight weeks; most people *finish* in seven. The answer depends on the question.
- 6 (a) notebook and (a) pen: "notebook and pen" fits three words; "a notebook and pen" is four words (over the limit). The laptop is the distractor.

◆ DIALOGUE – A PART 1 CALL

Correction: "Just the morning. Oh, actually, could we make it the whole day?" → whole day. **Distractor:** "Eight thirty on weekdays, but on Saturdays we open at nine." → 9:00. Possible form questions: *Surname* (NGUYEN) · *Phone* (07700 900163) · *Number of bikes* (2) · *Rental period* (whole day / full day) · *Price per bike* (\$35) · *Saturday opening time* (9:00 / 9 a.m.).

◆ INFORMATION GAP — BUILD THE TRAP

The answers are on each caller's identity card (materials, Set B). A form is correct when every detail matches the card, including the **final** version after the correction. Common mismatches: the first date instead of the corrected one, -teen / -ty house numbers, a doubled letter missed ("double S"), a phone number written with one group missing.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

"The trip's on the fourth of June — oh, sorry, that clashes with the exam, so it's been moved to the eleventh." Date of the trip?

A) 11 June

B) 4 June

C) the exam date

Why: "sorry" signals a correction, and the final version wins. B is the distractor; C isn't asked for.

Q2

"NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER." You hear "student identification cards."

A) student identification cards

B) identification cards

C) card

Why: A is three words (zero marks even though the meaning is right). C drops the plural and changes the answer. *ID cards* is also acceptable.

Q3 · new

"The talk is in the Garrick Building — that's G-A-double R-I-C-K." Gap: "_____ Building" (ONE WORD ONLY).

A) Garick

B) GARRICK

C) Garrick Building

Why: capitals are accepted, and the spelling follows the letters exactly ("double R"). A misses one R; C is two words and repeats a word already printed.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (2.1)

Writing the first answer heard instead of the correction (D) · -teen / -ty confusion (14 / 40, 15 / 50) · E and I, A and E, G and J swapped in spelled names · dropped plurals (*battery* for *batteries*) · repeating a printed word or unit (\$70, *spare batteries*, *Garrick Building*) and breaking the limit · large numbers off by a factor of ten · dates as numbers only (3/5) · left and right reversed on the plan because the learner never fixed the starting point · freezing after one missed gap and leaving the next two blank (L) · blanks at the end (in the real test, fill every one). For range, praise learners who predict precisely ("a plural noun, probably equipment"), who write the paraphrase pair beside a Part 4 answer, and who build natural corrections in the pair task ("Oh, did I say Tuesday? I meant Wednesday").

2.2 · IELTS READING — SKIMMING, SCANNING & QUESTION TYPES (C6)

◆ EXERCISE 1 — SKIM

a) Model: *Desire paths show where people really want to walk, and planners can use them as useful information.* Accept any line that includes both what desire paths are and the idea that they are useful to planners / design; "a passage about paths in parks" is too narrow (it misses the argument). b) D (Aldport) · c) E · d) F ("Perhaps the most important lesson...").

◆ EXERCISE 2 — SCAN RACE (SCRIPT 2.2-B)

1	2011 · D	4	three (campuses) · B
2	(urban) geographer · B	5	a / one landscape architect · F
3	fifteen / 15 · C	6	muddy shoes · D

What the eyes looked for: 1 four digits · 2 a capital letter (the name) · 3 a number word · 4 "campuses" · 5 quotation marks · 6 "staff" / "complained."

◆ EXERCISE 3 — QUESTIONS 1-13

Q	Answer	Evidence (paragraph) and the trap
1	maintenance problem	A: "For decades, they were treated as a maintenance problem." Not <i>problem</i> alone (the sentence needs the full noun phrase); <i>source of data</i> is the modern view (the opposite).
2	perceived safety / safety	B: "walkers weigh comfort and perceived safety alongside time." Both are within the limit. Not <i>distance</i> (that's "time").
3	clay	C: "on wet clay soil the figure was lower still" (= fewer crossings stop recovery = recovers less easily). This needs a moment's reasoning: good to discuss.
4	aerial photographs	D: "aerial photographs were taken each month." <i>aerial photograph</i> (singular) = wrong: copy the exact form in the text ("photographs ... were taken each month").
5	B	B: "paths appeared even though they were longer than the paved alternative." A: contradicted by the same sentence. C: word-match trap ("three university campuses" is where the <i>study</i> took place).
6	B	D: "far fewer shortcuts appeared than on comparable sites." A: the text says "not free," but never compares its cost with normal planning. C: contradicted: "some staff complained."
7	C	E: "may over-represent younger people ... may therefore miss the routes used by older residents or by people with limited mobility." A: contradicted ("with users' consent"). B: contradicted ("made the method cheaper").
8	desire lines	A: "desire paths" or "desire lines."
9	a (single) semester / one semester / a single semester	C: "within a single semester." All three versions are within three words.
10	drones	E: "drones can photograph worn grass far more cheaply than aircraft." Not <i>aircraft</i> (the more expensive option).
11	E	"Critics warn..." (a warning about digital data).
12	C	"becomes thinner and easier to see, and a visible line invites the next walker..."
13	A	"where people actually want to go rather than where designers expected them to walk."

Q	Question words	Passage words
1	in the past · regarded as	for decades · were treated as
2	consider · as well as	weigh · alongside
6	similar sites	comparable sites
7	without permission	(the opposite of) with users' consent
11	leave out some groups of people	miss the routes used by older residents or by people with limited mobility · over-represent younger people
12	more noticeable	easier to see · visible

◆ EXERCISE 5 – MY TIME BUDGET (MODELS)

a) Guess the three, mark them with a small dot to return to if time allows, and start Passage 2 now. b) Bank the time: start Passage 2 at once, and don't re-check Passage 1 now; Passage 3 is harder and needs it. c) Write a sensible guess in every blank (there's no penalty); for T/F/NG guess one label, for completion a word near the keyword. **Plan:** any plan that gives Passage 3 at least as long as Passage 1 is fine (for example 17 · 20 · 23 minutes, with the last 2 minutes for blanks).

◆ DIALOGUE – HOW DID YOU FIND IT?

Paraphrase pairs: *without permission* ↔ "with users' consent" (and the opposite meaning makes A a trap) · *all groups of people* ↔ "older residents" (people the data may miss). The option that is the **opposite** of the text is A (and B, too: "more expensive" vs "cheaper").

◆ EXPLAIN YOUR ROUTE (MATERIALS, SET C)

Card A: 1 steps (B: "saves more than a few steps") · 2 B, once the main routes had become clear (D: "Only after the main desire lines had become clear were they paved") · 3 F ("people are not obstacles to good design but participants in it"). **Card B:** 1 younger people (E) · 2 B, a visible line attracts more walkers (C: "a visible line invites the next walker to follow it") · 3 A ("a free and remarkably honest source of data").

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

You've just opened a new passage. What should you do first?

A) Read every sentence carefully from the top.

B) Start with the matching-information questions.

C) Skim the whole passage quickly for gist and structure.

Why: a 2–3 minute skim builds the map that makes every later scan faster. A is the biggest time-sink; B is the slowest question type, so it comes last.

Q2

"NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS." The passage says "aging equipment"; you write "the aging equipment."

A) Full marks

B) Half a mark

C) Zero: three words break the limit

Why: the limit is part of the marking, and there are no half marks. (British spelling *ageing* would also be accepted.)

Q3 · new

26 minutes on Passage 1, three questions left. Best move?

A) Keep working until you are sure.

B) Guess the three, mark them, and move to Passage 2 now.

C) Skip Passage 2 and go to Passage 3.

Why: Passage 1 is already six minutes over budget, and every question is worth one mark. A risks losing many easy marks later; C throws away Passage 2, which is usually easier than Passage 3.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (2.2)

Reading the whole passage slowly before looking at the questions (T) · choosing the option that repeats the text's words (M: Q5 C is the classic) · scanning for the question's exact words and never finding them (P) · breaking the limit with an extra word (Q1: "a" is already printed, so *the maintenance problem* is three words and wrong) · singular for plural (*aerial photograph*) · writing answers in the booklet and not on the answer sheet · doing matching information first and running out of time · spending 25+ minutes on Passage 1 · blanks. For range, praise learners who can say "*The question says X; the text says Y,*" who eliminate options with a reason, and who stick to their checkpoint times.

2.3 · TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN & MATCHING — THE TRICKY TYPES (C7)

◆ EXERCISE 1 — TRUE, FALSE OR NOT GIVEN? PROVE IT. (PASSAGE A)

#	Label	Sentence	Evidence (model)
1	TRUE	3	"Children who move to a new country usually develop a more native-like accent than their parents, particularly if they arrive before the age of about ten." (<i>arrive in a new country</i> = "move to a new country")

2	FALSE	4	Clash: "adults and teenagers often make faster progress than young children" vs "young children make faster progress."
3	NOT GIVEN	4	The text talks about note-taking as one strategy, but not about which strategy is <i>most effective</i> . (Qualifier trap: "the most.")
4	FALSE	5	Clash: "followed 400 adult learners for three years" vs "more than three years."
5	NOT GIVEN	5	The text talks about the number of learners (400 adults), but not about their gender.
6	TRUE	6	"practiced speaking with others at least twice a week were almost twice as likely to reach an intermediate level" (<i>regularly</i> = "at least twice a week"; <i>other people</i> = "others").
7	FALSE	7	Clash: "Age ... made surprisingly little difference to progress among learners between thirty and sixty" vs "the older ones made much slower progress."
8	TRUE	9	"learners who chose to join conversation groups may already have been more confident or more motivated" (<i>accepts</i> = "points out"; <i>from the start</i> = "already").
9	NOT GIVEN	10	The text says the study did not include learners over sixty, but says nothing about any <i>plans</i> for a future study.

Evidence sentences in the learners' own words are fine, as long as they quote or point to the right sentence and name the relationship (same meaning · clash · silent on).

◆ EXERCISE 2 – WHAT WENT WRONG?

- 1 K (used own knowledge) · correct label **NOT GIVEN**. "I've seen it myself" is not evidence from the text.
- 2 F (confused False and Not Given) · correct label **FALSE**. The text doesn't need exact speeds: "made surprisingly little difference" already clashes with "much slower."
- 3 Q (missed a qualifier) · correct label **NOT GIVEN**. Sentence 4 mentions note-taking, but "the most effective" is a ranking the text never makes. (Accept P / M if the learner explains it as a word-match: the word "note-taking" appears, but the idea doesn't.)

◆ EXERCISE 3 – MATCHING HEADINGS (PASSAGE B)

1 · Paragraph B	2 · Paragraph C	3 · Paragraph D	4 · Paragraph E	5 · Paragraph F
ii	iv	v	vi	viii

Main ideas (models): B LEDs save cities money · C blue light and sleep · D light harms night animals · E dimming didn't raise crime (maybe) · F smart lamps that respond. **Unused:** iii (*How screens affect our sleep*: the **detail trap** for C, which mentions screens in one sentence only) and vii (*A rise in crime after midnight*: a trap for E, and actually

contradicted: crime "did not rise"). Some learners choose ii for paragraph A because A mentions how lamps "were judged"; the example (A → i) prevents this.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – MATCHING FEATURES (PASSAGE B)

6	B Nair	C: "she recommends warmer-colored lamps for residential streets"
7	C the council	E: "According to the city council, reported crime on those streets did not rise"
8	A Hale	E: "he notes that crime was already falling across the country during the same period"
9	B Nair	F: "argues that residents should be consulted street by street"
10	A Hale	B: "estimates that the switch cut the city's lighting bill by more than half"
11	C the council	F: "Brenton council plans to install such systems on all residential streets by 2030"

Trap: Hale appears in E (item 7's paragraph), so learners who match by paragraph rather than by *who said it* write A for 7. The council reported the result; Hale questioned it.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – QUALIFIERS

- 1 F · qualifier *every* (the text says "some cities").
- 2 T · qualifier *usually*: the statement is *weaker* than the text ("several times longer"), so the text supports it.
- 3 NG · qualifier *never*. The text says bats "may avoid lit routes," but nothing about whether they ever hunt near lights. An over-claim against a hedged text is not automatically False: look for a clash.
- 4 NG · qualifier *sharply*. "Did not rise" could mean it stayed the same or fell; the text doesn't say it fell, let alone sharply.

Items 3 and 4 are the discussion items: they show that "too strong" can be False *or* Not Given, and the deciding question is still "Can I point to the clash?"

◆ DIALOGUE – FALSE OR NOT GIVEN?

Evidence language: "Can you point to the words that clash?" · "It doesn't say anything about..." · "It just doesn't tell us." · "False needs a clash." · "The text says 'three years,' whereas the statement says..." · "The text talks about..., but not about..." The deciding sentence: "**False needs a clash.**"

◆ PROVE IT DEBATE CARDS (MATERIALS, SET D)

Card	Answer	Evidence
1 · Teenagers learn vocabulary faster than adults in the first months.	NOT GIVEN	Sentence 4 groups "adults and teenagers" together and compares them with young children; it never compares teenagers with adults.

2 · The Marvel study included learners of all ages.	FALSE	Sentence 10: "Nor did the study include learners over sixty" (and sentence 5: "adult learners").
3 · Reyes thinks conversation groups may not be the only reason for the better results.	TRUE	Sentence 9: "the groups themselves may not explain all of the difference."
4 · Adults usually develop a better accent than children who move to a new country.	FALSE	Sentence 3: children "usually develop a more native-like accent than their parents."
5 · LED lamps are cheaper to buy than sodium lamps.	NOT GIVEN	Paragraph B says the initial purchase cost was "considerable" and LEDs are cheaper to run, but never compares purchase prices.
6 · Nair believes streetlights are the main cause of poor sleep.	FALSE	Paragraph C: "the effect of streetlights is small compared with that of phones and computer screens."
7 · Brenton dimmed the lights on every street after midnight.	FALSE	Paragraph E: "on quieter streets" ... "busy streets and the town center were never dimmed."
8 · Moths are the insects most affected by street lighting.	NOT GIVEN	Paragraph D mentions "moths and other night-flying insects" but does not rank insects.

◆ SELF - CHECK

Q1

"The museum opened in 1980." Statement: "The museum was the first of its kind in the country."

A) Not Given

B) False

C) True

Why: the text gives only a date. Nothing confirms "first of its kind," and nothing says it wasn't. No clash → Not Given.

Q2

A paragraph mainly about how solar panels are manufactured mentions once that they are expensive. Which heading is the trap?

A) "How solar panels are made"

B) "The high cost of solar panels"

C) "The production process of solar technology"

Why: B matches a single detail, not the main idea. A and C both describe manufacturing (in a real task only one of them would be offered).

Q3 · new

"Only a few species of frog can survive being frozen." Statement: "Most frogs can survive freezing."

A) True

B) False

C) Not Given

Why: "only a few" and "most" cannot both be true: you can point to the clash. The qualifier decides the answer.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (2.3)

False for Not Given ("It doesn't say that, so it's false") (F) · True or False from general knowledge (K) · missing qualifiers (*all, only, the most, much slower, sharply*) (Q) · "True" because the statement repeats the text's words even though the meaning differs (M) · headings matched to a detail or a word in the paragraph (H) · matching features by *paragraph* instead of by *person* · writing "Yes" on a True / False task, or "T" when the answer sheet requires a full word · in speaking: "The text don't say," "It is not say about," "Yes, it doesn't." For range, praise *whereas, there's no mention of, is a paraphrase of, the word "only" makes it false*, and learners who defend Not Given by naming what the text *does* talk about.

PRACTICE TEST 1 (C8) AND THE WORKBOOK RESULTS PAGE

The answers, accepted alternatives and the raw-score → band conversion table for Practice Test 1 are in [assessment/answer-keys.html](#). The workbook "Before the test" and "My results" page has no right answers; check only that each learner has (1) a raw score for each section, (2) a code beside every wrong answer, and (3) two leaks with a *specific* weekly practice task (not "study more"). Useful plan suggestions by code: **D** Trap Bingo and online lesson 2.1 Exercise 2 · **S / N** five-minute number and spelling dictations from any podcast with a transcript · **W** re-read the instruction and count words on every gap · **L** full timed Listening parts, never pausing · **P / M** paraphrase maps

(workbook 2.2 Ex 4) on every practice set · **O** / **T** strict 20-minute passages with a timer · **F** / **K** / **Q** one T / F / NG set a week with a written evidence sentence · **H** write a five-word main idea for each paragraph of any article.

Module 3 — Academic Writing: Answers

Answers to every Module 3 workbook exercise and self-check question, with the "why," acceptable alternatives, annotated band-7 model answers for the timed tasks (the bar-chart report, the table and process reports, the problem–solution essay), the Examiner Panel estimates with examiner-style commentary, and the errors you can expect to meet most.

Lessons 3.1–3.3

Classes C9–C11

9 self-check items

14 exercises • 4 models

MARKING PRINCIPLE

Writing has **criteria**, not answers. For the closed items (trend words, prepositions, question types, which criterion), there is one best answer and the key gives it. For everything else, the models are *examples* of band-7 writing, not the answer. Accept any version that (1) does the job the task sets (an overview with no figures; a thesis with a position; one idea developed), (2) is accurate (figures read correctly from the chart, *a rise in*, *rose* not *rised*) and (3) stays in a formal, objective register. All bands in this key are **estimates**: say "about band 6.5," never "this is a 6.5." American English is the model; accept British spellings and forms (*summarise*, *levelling off*, *programme*, *per cent*, *favour*), which IELTS also accepts, as long as the learner is consistent. Contractions are not appropriate in either task.

3.1 • WRITING TASK 1 — DESCRIBING DATA (C9)

◆ PRACTICE TEST 1 — MY RESULTS (TALLY)

No answers: each learner's grid is personal. Check two things as you circulate: every lost mark has a stroke somewhere (learners skip the painful ones), and the "one thing I will do" is **concrete**. ✗ "Practice more." ✓ "Check plurals: after each Listening section, read every answer and ask 'one or more than one?'" Raw scores convert to approximate bands with the table in [assessment/answer-keys.html](#).

◆ EXERCISE 1 — THE JOBS OF THE PARAGRAPHS (CHART 1 MODEL)

- 1 B • No.
- 2 A • *percentage* → *proportion* • *shows* → *compares* • *between 2004 and 2024* → *at four-year intervals between 2004 and 2024* (accept any two genuine changes).
- 3 By **pattern**, not by year: C = the starting point for all three plus Northport's rise; D = Riverton's later rise, contrasted with Eastvale's decline.

- 4 Any two: *declined slightly* · *rose steadily* · *climbing steeply* · *increased sharply* · *remained very low* (accept *remained stable* as a verb + adjective pattern if the learner explains it).
- 5 *overtaking* · *drawing level with* (also accept *at 12% in 2012* described as "the same").
- 6 No. It reports only what the chart shows. *As a result* in B links two facts from the chart, not a real-world cause.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – CHOOSE THE ACCURATE WORDS

1 **slightly** (6 → 8) · 2 **by** (6 → 31 = 25 points) · 3 **rise** (noun after *a steep*) · 4 **remained stable** (10 → 10) · 5 **rose** (*raise* needs an object) · 6 **three times** (31 vs 10) · 7 **respectively** · 8 **of** (the amount; *in* would introduce the topic: *a decline of 4 points in cycling*)

Percent vs percentage points: strong learners may ask. 6% → 31% is a rise of 25 *percentage points*; "rose by 25%" would technically mean 6 × 1.25. Accept *points* or *percentage points*; don't penalize "by 25%" at this level, but mention it to stretch learners.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – THE OVERVIEW (CHART 3, PIE)

Model: "Overall, renewable sources generated the great majority of Lakeland's electricity in 2024, with hydroelectric power and wind together producing around three fifths of the total. Fossil fuels played a much smaller role, and coal accounted for only a small share."

Accept any overview that names the **largest** source(s) and the **smallest** or a clear contrast (renewable vs fossil), with no exact figures. Approximations (*around three fifths, the majority*) are acceptable in an overview; exact percentages are not. **Watch for:** "Overall, hydro is 34%..." (figure) · a list of all six sources · "which is good for the environment" (opinion).

◆ EXERCISE 4 – SELECT AND GROUP (CHART 4, TABLE)

- 1 Elston (51 minutes) · Dunmore (19 minutes)
- 2 Dunmore (52%)
- 3 Brenton (45%)
- 4 The larger the share of commuters who drove, the longer the average commute: Elston 70% / 51 min → Ashby 61% / 42 → Calder 48% / 35 → Brenton 35% / 28 → Dunmore 22% / 19. Report the pattern; don't claim the cars *cause* the long commutes.
- 5 One good grouping: **Body A** Elston and Ashby (long commutes, car-dominated), with Calder as the middle case · **Body B** Dunmore and Brenton (short commutes; walking/cycling or public transportation as the main mode). Accept other logical groupings that are justified.

Model report (band 7, 173 words):

The table compares the average length of a one-way commute in five cities in 2024, together with the proportion of commuters who traveled by car, by public transportation and on foot or by bicycle.

Overall, the cities where driving was most common also had the longest commutes, whereas the shortest journeys were found where most people walked or cycled. Dunmore stood out as the only city in which active travel was the main mode.

Elston and Ashby had the longest average commutes, at 51 and 42 minutes respectively, and in both cities the car was by far the dominant mode, used by 70% and 61% of commuters. Walking and cycling were rare in these two cities, at 5% and 9%.

At the other end of the scale, the average journey in Dunmore took only 19 minutes, and just over half of its commuters (52%) walked or cycled. Brenton and Calder fell between these extremes, with commutes of 28 and 35 minutes; Brenton was the only city where public transportation was the most popular choice, at 45%.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – A PROCESS (CHART 5)

- 1 **First**, rain falls on the school roof and **runs / flows** into gutters and downpipes. (Active: rain *falls* and *runs* are intransitive, so no passive is possible. A good teaching point.)
- 2 **Next / Then**, leaves and dirt **are removed** by a leaf screen.
- 3 **After that**, the water **is stored** in an underground tank.
- 4 **Next / Then**, it **is pumped** to a filter unit, where it **is filtered and treated with UV (ultraviolet) light**.
- 5 **Finally**, the clean water **is used** to flush toilets and water the garden.
- 6 "Overall, the process has seven stages, from rain falling on the roof to the treated water being used in the building. It is linear rather than cyclical, although surplus water leaves the system when the tank is full."

Model report (band 7, 164 words):

The diagram illustrates the process by which rainwater is collected from the roof of a school building, cleaned and then reused.

Overall, there are seven stages in the process, which begins with rain falling on the roof and ends with the treated water being used for the school's toilets and garden. It is a linear rather than a cyclical process, although excess water can leave the system at the storage stage.

First, rain falls on the school roof and runs into the gutters and downpipes. It then passes through a leaf screen, where leaves and dirt are removed. After that, the water is stored in an underground tank. If this tank becomes full, the overflow is directed into a storm drain.

At the next stage, the stored water is pumped to a filter unit, where it is filtered and then treated with ultraviolet light. Once it has been cleaned in this way, the water is finally used to flush the toilets and to water the school garden.

Watch for: *is fall / is run* (passive with intransitive verbs) · missing *is* ("the water stored in a tank") · every sentence beginning "Then" · adding what the diagram doesn't say ("so the school saves money").

◆ DIALOGUE – CHECKING THE OVERVIEW

Overview 1: "Overall, paid work increased from 6 to 12 hours, and lectures fell from 14 to 11." Overview 2: "Overall, students spent more time on paid work and online lessons, and less on lectures and independent study." The second is better because it gives the **shape** (what grew, what shrank) with no figures and groups the activities. Ravi's advice: don't give a reason ("because students need more money"); the chart doesn't show why. Report that paid work became the most time-consuming activity instead.

◆ CHART TALK – MODEL DESCRIPTIONS (SET C)

Pair 1 A (recycling): "Overall, the share of waste recycled in Hollin more than doubled. It rose gradually from 18% to 22% between 2010 and 2013, then jumped to 35% by 2016. After a small dip to 40% in 2022, it reached a high of 44% in 2024." · **Pair 1 B (waste per person):** "Overall, household waste per person fell steadily, from 11 kilograms a week to 8.4, with one very small rise in 2019." · **Pair 2 A (news):** "Phone apps were by far the most common source, used by just under half of adults. Television came second at about a fifth; websites and radio had the same share, 12%; printed newspapers were the least common, at 8%." · **Pair 2 B (museum):** "Visitor numbers were lowest in February, at 8,000, climbed through spring and peaked in August at 32,000, roughly four times the winter low. They then fell sharply in September, before a smaller rise in December."

◆ TIMED TASK – CHART 2, BAR CHART: ANNOTATED BAND-7 MODEL (161 WORDS)

[**Introduction: paraphrase what, who, when**] The bar chart compares the average number of hours per week that first-year students at one university spent on five activities in 2014 and 2024.

[**Overview: grouped, no figures, the most striking feature**] Overall, time spent on paid work and online video lessons rose considerably over the decade, while the hours devoted to lectures, seminars and independent study fell. The most striking change is that paid work, which had been only the third most time-consuming activity, became the largest in 2024.

[**Body A: the falling group, with figures**] In 2014, lectures and seminars took up the most time, at 14 hours a week, followed by independent study at 10 hours. Both declined over the period, to 11 and 8 hours respectively.

[**Body B: the rising group, comparisons**] By contrast, the time students spent in paid work doubled from 6 to 12 hours, overtaking lectures and seminars. The rise in online video lessons was even more dramatic in relative terms: a fivefold increase from just one hour to five. Group projects, meanwhile, changed very little, rising only slightly from 3 to 4 hours.

WHY THIS IS ABOUT BAND 7 FOR TASK ACHIEVEMENT

The overview is explicit, grouped (rising vs falling) and figure-free, and it names the most striking feature (paid work overtaking lectures). The body paragraphs follow the overview's grouping, not the order of the bars. Every figure is accurate. Comparison language is varied (*followed by, respectively, by contrast, overtaking, even more dramatic in relative terms, meanwhile*) and the trend language is precise (*doubled, a fivefold increase, rising only slightly*). No cause is given for any change. To reach band 8, a writer might note more precisely that paid work (12 hours) exceeded lectures (11) by only one hour, and integrate the small change in group projects into the overview's pattern.

Common problems in learners' versions: overview with numbers · going bar by bar, 2014 then 2024 · "because students need money / because of the internet" (invented causes) · "paid work increased to 6 hours" (confusing to

and by) · "online video lessons increased 400%" (possible, but many learners compute it wrongly; *fivefold* is safer) · "In 2024 year" · under 150 words because the introduction was copied.

◆ SELF - CHECK

Q1

Which paragraph of a Task 1 report is the most important for your band, and why?

A) The introduction, because it comes first.

B) The overview: without a clear one, Task Achievement is capped around band 5.

C) The first body paragraph, because it has the most figures.

Why: the descriptors (paraphrased) link a clear overview to band 6 and above; a report that recounts details with no overview stays around band 5 for Task Achievement, however accurate the figures.

Q2

A value drops from 90 to 12 in a single year. Which is the most accurate description?

A) It declined gradually.

B) It fluctuated.

C) It plummeted / fell sharply.

Why: a very large drop in a short time needs a strong verb or adverb. *Gradually* is slow and small; *fluctuated* means up and down.

Q3 · new

Which sentence about Chart 2 is accurate and suitable for a Task 1 report?

A) Time spent on paid work rose from 6 to 12 hours, doubling over the period.

B) Paid work rised by 12 hours because students need more money.

C) I think paid work increased a lot, which is worrying.

Why: A is accurate and objective. B has a wrong verb form (*rised*), a wrong figure (by 6, not 12) and an invented cause. C gives an opinion and vague language.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (3.1)

No overview, or figures in it · "In conclusion" repeating the overview · describing every bar or year in order · invented causes · *rised* / *was risen* / *raised* · *an increase of cycling* · *to* vs *by* confused · *the 60% of* · *The number of students were* · present tense for past data · *percent* vs *percentage* · plural -s dropped (*five activity, 12 hour*) · copying the prompt word for word (copied words don't show the examiner your own language) · under 150 words. For range, praise *overtook*, *drew level with*, *a fivefold increase*, *respectively*, *just under a third*, and a clean past perfect (*had overtaken by 2016*).

3.2 · WRITING TASK 2 — ESSAY STRUCTURE & ARGUMENT (C10)

◆ EXERCISE 1 — WHAT'S THE JOB?

Prompt	Type	Parts	Structure
P1 cooking	Opinion (agree / disagree)	1 (my position, and to what extent)	thesis with a position · 2 bodies supporting it (or 1 concession + 1 main)
P2 food waste	Discussion	3 (view A · view B · my opinion)	body 1 households · body 2 businesses · opinion in thesis and conclusion
P3 sitting	Problem–solution	2 (problems · measures)	body 1 problems · body 2 solutions
P4 adults returning	Two-part (direct questions)	2 (why · is it positive)	body 1 reasons · body 2 evaluation with a clear answer
P5 flexible hours	Advantages–disadvantages	3 (advantages · disadvantages · verdict)	body 1 · body 2 · a verdict in thesis and conclusion

Accept 2 for P5 if the learner writes "both sides + verdict." The key point is that P5 needs a **judgment**, not just two lists.

◆ EXERCISE 2 — UPGRADE THE THESIS (MODELS)

- 1 I strongly agree that cooking should be a regular part of the secondary school timetable, as it gives young people a practical skill they will use every day.
- 2 Although flexible hours can make teamwork harder to organize, I believe their benefits for both employees and employers are far greater.
- 3 While better habits at home would help, I believe supermarkets and restaurants should carry most of the responsibility for reducing food waste.
- 4 Adults are returning to education mainly because the job market is changing, and in my view this is a largely positive development.

Accept any thesis that answers the question with a position. For P1 a partial position is fine (*I partly agree..., provided that...*) if it is stated clearly. **Watch for:** "This essay will discuss..." with no position · a general statement about the topic · "I will agree" (future).

◆ EXERCISE 3 – THE FIVE-MINUTE PLAN

	P2 (teacher's think-aloud)	P1 (one possible plan)
Type · parts	Discussion · 3	Opinion · 1
Position	Businesses bear greater responsibility.	Strongly agree: cooking should be on the timetable.
Body 1	Households waste a lot → planning and storing saves food and money → e.g. a community cooking course	A life skill for independence → cheap, healthy meals, less fast food → e.g. a school where every student learns three simple dishes
Body 2	Businesses encourage over-buying → multipacks, "buy one, get one free," big portions → rules reach millions at once	It supports other subjects → measuring = math, ingredients = science → e.g. a class that calculates the cost of a meal
Conclusion	Education is worthwhile, but business rules work faster and wider.	Restate: a practical skill that belongs in every timetable.

Judge plans by the structure: type right, every part covered, one idea per body with a *because* and an example. Learners may disagree with the position; that's fine.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – DEVELOP A THIN POINT (MODEL)

[Topic sentence] One of the clearest benefits of flexible hours is that they allow working parents to balance their jobs and family responsibilities. **[Why]** When employees can start earlier or later, they are able to take children to school or collect them without asking for time off. **[So what]** As a result, they are likely to feel less stressed and more loyal to their employer, which means companies lose fewer experienced staff. **[Example]** A small accounting firm that lets staff choose to start at any time between 7 and 10 a.m., for instance, might find that parents who would otherwise have left stay with the company for years.

Accept a developed paragraph on any one of the four ideas (parents, less traffic, companies). The key: **one** idea with a why, a consequence and a specific example, not four ideas.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – MODEL ESSAY A

- 1 "While educating households has clear value, I believe that the greater responsibility lies with supermarkets and restaurants, because their decisions shape what everyone else buys and throws away." Position: businesses should carry more of the responsibility.
- 2 View A (households) = paragraph 2 · view B (businesses) = paragraph 3 · the writer's opinion = the thesis (paragraph 1) and the conclusion (paragraph 4); paragraph 3's topic sentence also signals it.

- 3 "However, individual effort can only go so far when businesses encourage over-buying."
- 4 "...they buy less and discard less, which also saves them money." (Also accept "a habit that may last for years" or "children who grow up in these households often learn the same habits.")
- 5 No. It restates the position in new words.
- 6 "While educating households has clear value..." or "teaching households to manage food better is worthwhile, but..."

◆ DIALOGUE – TWO WAYS TO PLAN

Ana forgot that the prompt has **two** questions ("Why is this happening?" and "Is it a positive development?"); she planned only the second. "Push it" = develop the point: ask why and so what, and add an example. Ana's thesis: "Mostly positive, as long as courses are affordable" (in an essay: *...this is a largely positive development, provided that courses remain affordable*).

◆ TIMED TASK – P3 (SITTING AT WORK): ANNOTATED BAND-7 MODEL (259 WORDS)

[Introduction: paraphrase + thesis covering both parts] In many modern jobs, employees spend seven or eight hours a day in a chair, often in front of a screen. This lifestyle creates problems for both physical and mental health, but a combination of workplace changes and personal habits could reduce its effects considerably.

[Body 1: problems. Topic sentence → why → so what → second, linked problem] The most serious problem is the impact on the body. When people sit for long periods, they burn very little energy, and over time this can contribute to weight gain, back pain and poor circulation. These conditions are not only uncomfortable for the individual; they also lead to more sick days, which affects employers as well. Long hours at a desk can also harm concentration and mood, since workers rarely move, go outside or take a genuine break from their tasks.

[Body 2: solutions. Topic sentence → two measures (employer, individual) → example → so what] Fortunately, several practical measures could address these issues. Employers could provide adjustable desks that allow staff to stand for part of the day, and they could encourage short walking breaks by holding some meetings on foot. Such changes cost relatively little but make movement a normal part of work. At the same time, individuals can take responsibility for their own routines, for instance by setting a reminder to stand up every half hour or by cycling or walking at least part of the way to work. Small habits like these, repeated daily, add up to a meaningful difference.

[Conclusion: restates both parts, no new idea] In conclusion, a largely seated working day can damage both physical and mental well-being. However, if companies make it easier to move and workers build activity into their routines, these problems can be significantly reduced.

WHY THIS IS ABOUT BAND 7 OR ABOVE

TR: both parts of the prompt are answered in proportion, and the thesis previews both. **CC:** one idea per body, clear topic sentences, and cohesion carried by referencing (*This lifestyle, These conditions, these issues, Such changes, Small habits like these, these problems*) rather than a stack of linkers. **LR:** precise collocations (*burn energy, poor circulation, take a genuine break, a meaningful difference*). **GRA:** a range of complex forms (*when..., not only... but also, which affects..., by setting...*) with no errors. Hedging (*can contribute to, could reduce*) avoids overclaiming.

◆ TIMED TASK – P5 (FLEXIBLE HOURS): PLAN AND OPENING

Plan: Advantages–disadvantages · verdict: advantages outweigh · Body 1 (disadvantages first, then turn): harder to schedule meetings and cover customers → e.g. a team that can't meet until 11 a.m. → can be solved with "core hours" · Body 2 (advantages): staff work when they are most productive, parents balance family, less rush-hour travel → e.g. a firm that keeps experienced parents · Conclusion: with core hours, the benefits are greater.

Model introduction: A growing number of employers now allow staff to decide when they start and finish work. Although this flexibility can make teamwork harder to organize, I believe its advantages for both employees and companies clearly outweigh this drawback.

Accept either verdict, or a balanced one (*the advantages outweigh the disadvantages only when...*), if it is clear.

Common fault: two lists and no verdict, so the question "Do the advantages outweigh...?" is never answered.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

A prompt says "Discuss both views and give your own opinion." Which approach best answers it?

A) Present both views fairly, and make your own opinion clear in the introduction and conclusion.

B) Argue strongly for the view you hold and ignore the other.

C) List as many arguments as possible from both sides and give no opinion.

Why: a discussion prompt has three jobs: view A, view B and your opinion. B misses a view; C misses the opinion. Either caps Task Response.

Q2

What is the main job of the thesis in your introduction?

A) To give a detailed example supporting one side.

B) To state your position or answer to the question clearly.

C) To copy the exam question word for word.

Why: the thesis is the answer to the whole question. Examples belong in body paragraphs; copied words from the prompt show the examiner none of your own language.

Q3 · new

"More adults are returning to education. Why is this happening? Is it a positive development?" Which plan fits best?

A) Body 1: advantages · Body 2: disadvantages · no opinion.

B) Three body paragraphs, all about why it is positive.

C) Body 1: the reasons · Body 2: whether it is positive, with a clear answer.

Why: a two-part question needs a direct answer to **each** question. A treats it as an advantages–disadvantages essay and gives no answer; B ignores "Why is this happening?"

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (3.2)

Answering the topic, not the question (one part missing) · no position, or a position that changes · "This essay will discuss..." as the whole thesis · four listed ideas in one paragraph · a new idea in the conclusion · memorized openers ("In this modern era," "As the saying goes") · *Although... but...* · *On the contrary* for *On the other hand* · comma splices · *people is* · contractions and *you* in formal writing · invented statistics ("87% of experts agree") · under 250 words. For range, praise a qualified thesis (*largely positive, provided that...*), a concession and rebuttal (*Admittedly... However...*) and precise hedging (*can contribute to, tend to*).

3.3 · COHERENCE, COHESION & THE BAND CRITERIA (C11)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – WHICH CRITERION?

1 TR (no position) · 2 CC (mechanical over-linking) · 3 LR (repetition, no range) · 4 GRA (no range of structures) · 5 CC (no paragraphing) · 6 GRA (accuracy: articles) · 7 TR (a part of the task missing) · 8 LR (collocation and spelling)

Items 2 and 5 both hit CC: cohesion is about much more than "using linkers." Accept a learner's argument that 8 touches GRA (*do a mistake* is often discussed as grammar), but collocation and spelling belong to LR.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – FIX THE OVER-LINKED PARAGRAPH (MODEL)

As more people shop online, the number of home deliveries is rising sharply. This trend has a visible cost: delivery vans increasingly fill residential streets, and much of the packaging they bring is thrown away after a single use. Companies therefore have a responsibility to find solutions, such as grouping deliveries or using reusable packaging.

Seven signposts became two or three (*As, therefore, such as*), with one summary noun (*This trend*) and ideas combined. Accept any version with 2–3 well-chosen links, at least one *this / these + noun*, and the empty sentences ("In conclusion, action is needed") cut or merged. **Watch for:** versions that simply delete the linkers and leave seven disconnected sentences.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – NAME IT WITH A SUMMARY NOUN

- 1 **This trend** (also *This change, This development*)
- 2 **This measure / This decision / This rule** (also *Such a ban*)
- 3 **This scheme / This approach / Such a service**
- 4 **This view / This idea / Such a proposal**
- 5 **These trends / These changes / These developments** (plural: the verb is *affect*)
- 6 **This risk / This possibility / Such a cut**

Accept any noun that names the whole previous idea and agrees with the verb. ✗ "This" alone (vague) · ✗ "This measure" in 1 (nobody took an action) · ✗ "These change."

◆ EXERCISE 4 – MAKE IT COHERENT (MODEL)

Order: c → d → a → b. Model: "Ready-made meals offer busy families clear savings, but at a cost. Many families now buy them to save time, and **these meals** are often cheaper than cooking from fresh ingredients, so the money saved can be used for other household costs. **However**, the food is not always as healthy as it looks."

Accept any logical topic sentence that signals the trade-off (convenience vs health). The reference (*these meals / they*) and one linker (*However, or so*) are the target.

◆ EXAMINER PANEL – ESTIMATES (FULL COMMENTARY IN SET E OF THE CLASSROOM MATERIALS)

Script	TR	CC	LR	GRA	Overall (about)	Key evidence
A	7	6	6	7	6.5	clear position held throughout; developed examples; mechanical <i>Firstly / Also / Secondly / Therefore</i> ; "make a research," "less people"; good complex sentences, one agreement slip
B	6	5	5	6	5.5	position blurred, new idea in conclusion, ideas listed; a linker on nearly every sentence, "Moreover" misused; "important" ×5,

						memorized opener, "dont / goverment / english"; mostly simple sentences, verb-pattern errors (<i>stop to go, enjoy to read</i>)
C	8	7	8	7	7.5	qualified position, specific support, risk answered; flexible referencing, slightly formulaic linkers; wide, precise vocabulary; three grammar slips (<i>the reading, Visitors... passes</i> , a comma splice)

Accept a panel's estimate within half a band of these if the panel quotes the script. The most common disagreements: (1) panels mark Script B's TR at 5 because of the blurred position and new idea in the conclusion (defensible; the commentary calls it "a low 6"); (2) panels mark Script A's TR at 6 because the counter-argument paragraph is short (the position is clear throughout and two ideas are developed, which points to 7); (3) panels over-reward Script B's CC for "using lots of linkers": this is exactly the misconception the lesson targets. Nobody should be marked "wrong" for a well-evidenced half-band difference.

◆ MY ESSAY – FOUR PASSES

No fixed answers. Check that each estimate has a **quotation** and each improvement is **concrete**: ✗ "better vocabulary" ✓ "replace three of my six *important*s with *essential, significant, a priority*" · ✗ "better grammar" ✓ "check every *the number of...* has a singular verb." Learners often **overestimate LR and GRA** and **underestimate TR**. When you read their grids before C12, write one line where your estimate differs by more than half a band.

◆ DIALOGUE – COMPARING ESTIMATES

Disagreeing politely: "Why did we go lower?" · "It is short, but..." · "I'd argue the Coherence is a 5, not a 6." Accepting a point: "Fair point." · "OK, I'm convinced." · "Exactly."

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

A writer begins every sentence with "Firstly, Moreover, In addition, Consequently, In conclusion." What is the likely effect on the Coherence & Cohesion band?

A) It raises the band: lots of linking words.

B) No effect: linkers aren't marked.

C) It lowers the band: the linking is mechanical and overused.

Why: the descriptors (paraphrased) reward linking that is natural and accurate and mark down overuse. Linkers are marked (B is wrong), but more is not better (A).

Q2

An essay answers a different question from the one in the prompt, but it is well organized and grammatically excellent. Which criterion is most affected?

A) Task Response

B) Coherence & Cohesion

C) Grammatical Range & Accuracy

Why: TR judges whether the essay answers **this** question. Organization and grammar may score well, but an off-topic response is heavily penalized under TR.

Q3 · new

"Cities face heavy traffic, poor air quality and crowded trains." Which next sentence has the clearest cohesion?

A) Moreover, this makes it essential.

B) These pressures make government action essential.

C) Cities face heavy traffic, poor air quality and crowded trains, so government action is essential.

Why: *These pressures* is a summary noun that points back to all three problems and names them. A uses a wrong linker (*Moreover* adds nothing) and two vague references (*this, it*). C repeats the whole sentence.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (3.3)

A linker on every sentence · *Moreover* / *In addition* used for contrast · *Consequently* / *Therefore* with no real result · a vague *this* / *it* pointing at a whole paragraph · the same noun repeated where a summary noun would do · one-block essays or very long paragraphs · no topic sentences · learners who judge the **writer** instead of the script · band estimates with no evidence · polishing the strongest criterion instead of the weakest. For range, praise flexible reference chains (*remote work* → *this arrangement* → *such flexibility*), a well-placed *That said*, and paragraphs that link by meaning without a signpost.

Module 4 — Speaking & Test Mastery: Answers

Answers to every Module 4 workbook exercise and self-check question, with the "why," acceptable alternatives, model versions for the open speaking and planning tasks, guidance for the Practice Test 2 band profile page, and the errors you can expect to meet most. Practice Test 2 answers are in [assessment/practice-test-2-key.html](#), not here.

Lessons 4.1–4.3 + PT2 page

Classes C12–C16

9 self-check items

15 exercises

MARKING PRINCIPLE

Most Module 4 tasks are spoken or open, so the models below are *examples*, not the answer. For extension tasks, accept any answer that (1) actually answers the question first, (2) adds at least a reason and an example or detail, and (3) stays at Part 1 length (2–3 sentences) or Part 3 length (3–4 sentences). For vocabulary upgrades, accept any word that is **precise and natural in context**, not just "bigger." For pronunciation items, accept regional variation that keeps the stress pattern clear; never mark an accent as wrong. American English is the model; accept British spellings and words (*memorise*, *practise*, *favourite*, *flat*, *centre*, *travelling*) and British date forms (*the fourteenth of May*).

4.1 • SPEAKING PARTS 1–3 (C12)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – TWO CANDIDATES (SCRIPT 4.1-A)

Diego	Answer	Why	Example	Contrast	Experience	Hypothetical
1 Work or study	✓	✓	✓			
2 Mornings or evenings	✓			✓		✓
3 Music	✓	✓			✓	
4 Travel around the city	✓	✓	✓			

Why Hana scores lower: her answers are correct but one line long ("I study." "Evenings." "Yes, I like it." "By bus."), so the examiner has almost no language to mark: no range, no linking, no evidence of fluency. Accept any answer that says "too short / no reasons or examples / nothing to mark." Learners may also tick "why" for Diego's Q2 ("I'm at my best at six a.m."); accept it, since it works as a reason as well as part of the contrast.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – GROW THE ANSWER (MODELS)

- 1 "Yes, I really do. It's the easiest way to clear my head after a day at a desk. Most evenings, for instance, I walk to the river and back, which takes about forty minutes."

- 2 "Definitely the evening. My brain seems to wake up after dinner, whereas in the morning I'm still half asleep. Last week, for example, I finished a whole practice Reading test at ten at night and got my best score."
- 3 "Not really, unfortunately. There's a small square with a few benches, but it's mostly concrete. If I could change one thing about my neighborhood, I'd turn the empty parking lot into a proper park."
- 4 "Pretty much every day, yes. I listen on the bus because it makes the commute go faster. At the moment I'm listening to a lot of old soul music that my uncle recommended."
- 5 "Not much, to be honest. Rain makes the buses slow and crowded, so everything takes longer. Unlike some people, I don't find it cozy at all: I'd much rather have cold, sunny weather."

Check each answer for: a direct answer first, a reason, and an example or detail. **Not yet:** three sentences that all repeat the answer ("Yes. I like walking. Walking is good."), a Part 1 answer longer than about 30 seconds (a mini-speech), or a reason with no connection ("Yes, because."). **Errors to expect:** "since two years," "I am agree," "the most of people," "I like very much walking."

◆ EXERCISE 3 – MATCH THE MOVE

1 Answer	2 Why	3 Example	4 Contrast	5 Experience	6 Hypothetical
c	e	a	f	d	b

Signals to point out: *because* (why) · *for instance* + past (example) · *Unlike...* (contrast) · *I remember* + -ing (experience) · *If I lived..., I'd...* (hypothetical, second conditional).

◆ EXERCISE 4 – THE PREP MINUTE (A MODEL NOTE-SET)

What	fixing a bike · brakes + flat tire	Who	neighbor, Mr. Okafor · retired mechanic
How long	3 Saturdays · YouTube too	Feeling	clumsy → proud · saved \$
Personal angle	bike stolen before → bought cheap one → it kept breaking		
My ending	now I fix friends' bikes · "learning with your hands sticks"		

Any note-set is correct if it is **keywords, not sentences**, has one cluster per bullet, and includes a personal angle and an ending that can stretch the talk to two minutes. A learner who wrote full sentences should try again with a strict 60 seconds. Picture notes (sketches) are fine: the test only needs notes *you* can read.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – ORDER THE PART 3 ANSWER

b → d → a → c → e (opinion → reason → other view → resolution → future)

Model for the follow-up question ("Should cities spend more money on parks?"): "I'd argue that they should, yes (*opinion*). Green spaces give people somewhere free to exercise and relax, which matters a lot in crowded neighborhoods (*reason*). That said, city budgets are limited, and some people would put housing or transportation first (*other view*). So perhaps the answer is smaller parks in more places rather than one expensive showpiece

(*resolution*). In the long run, I imagine parks will be seen as part of a city's health system (*future*). Accept any answer with an opinion, a reason and another view; the resolution and future moves are a band 7+ bonus.

◆ DIALOGUE – THE START OF THE TEST

Reason: "because you can see exactly what you've achieved at the end of the day." Contrast: "which sounds dull, but I find it surprisingly satisfying" (also accept "Mostly, yes... The only drawback is the noise"). Hypothetical: "If I could change one thing, I'd move that highway a mile away!" **Asking for something to write with:** the examiner provides paper and a pencil for Part 2 notes; asking for anything you need, or for a question to be repeated, is normal and doesn't lower the score.

◆ SPEAKING – MOCK-EXAMINER TRIOS

No fixed answers. A strong candidate: Part 1 answers of 2–3 sentences, a Part 2 talk that reaches or nearly reaches two minutes and covers every bullet, and Part 3 answers with at least an opinion, a reason and another view. Observers should quote, not judge ("You said 'That said, some people...': great"). A Part 2 time under 90 seconds is useful data for the next practice, not a failure.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

"Do you like reading?" Which response gives the best chance of a high fluency score?

A) "Yes, I do."

B) A long, rehearsed speech learned by heart.

C) "I love it, actually — it's how I switch off before bed. Lately I've been reading a lot of crime novels."

Why: C answers, gives a reason and adds a detail: extended but natural. A gives the examiner nothing to mark. B sounds memorized; examiners notice rehearsed speech and it doesn't fit the question, which hurts the score.

Q2

What's the best use of the one-minute prep time?

A) Write out the whole answer.

B) Jot keywords for each bullet plus a personal angle, and plan how to fill two minutes.

C) Sit quietly without writing.

Why: you can't write a full answer in 60 seconds, and reading one aloud would sound unnatural. Keywords give you a map; the personal angle gives you more to say. C wastes the only planning help the test gives you.

Part 3: "Why do some people prefer to shop online?" Which answer is strongest?

A) "Because it's easy."

B) "I'd say convenience is the main reason... That said, some people still prefer stores... so I suspect both will survive."

C) "I shop online every week. Yesterday I bought some shoes."

Why: B gives an opinion, a reason with a detail, another view and a prediction: a small argument. A is a one-line reason. C answers a Part 1 question about the candidate, not the general Part 3 question about people.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (4.1)

"I am agree" · "I live here since two years" · "people is" · "the most of people" · "I like very much..." · "My hometown very beautiful" (missing *be*) · he/she mix-ups in Part 2 stories · Part 1 mini-speeches of a minute or more · Part 2 talks that stop at 50–70 seconds · Part 3 answers that give an opinion with no reason · the same filler at the start of every answer ("Well, it's a good question...") · memorized openings ("Let me introduce my hometown"). For range, praise *That said, ..., I suppose it's possible that..., Unlike..., I...* and any natural hypothetical.

4.2 · PRONUNCIATION, LEXICAL RANGE & BAND DESCRIPTORS (C13)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – SAME IDEA, TWO BANDS (SCRIPT 4.2-A)

1	2	3	4	5	6
go-to	bustling	catch up	vividly	wide range	recharged

Higher version: the second one (about band 7); the first is about band 5. Reasons to accept: precise, less common words (*bustling, vividly, recharged*), collocations (*catch up on the week, a wide range of spices*), an idiomatic expression (*my go-to place*), a paraphrase instead of silence, varied sentences. The first version repeats *nice, good, a lot of, things* and uses only simple sentences. **The paraphrase:** "that thing — I don't know the exact word — where you argue a bit about the price and both sides end up happy." **The missing word:** *haggling* (accept *bargaining*).

◆ EXERCISE 2 – WORD STRESS

- 1 PHOtograph
- 2 phoTOgraphy
- 3 photoGRAPhic
- 4 COMfortable

- 5 eCOmomy
- 6 ecoNOMic
- 7 enVIronment
- 8 techNOlogy
- 9 deVELOpment
- 10 NEcessary
- 11 INteresting
- 12 VEGetable

Lost syllables in natural speech: *comfortable* (COMF-ta-ble), *interesting* (IN-tres-ting), *vegetable* (VEJ-ta-ble). Accept *necessary* said with three syllables as a fourth answer. For *economic*, the first vowel may be "ee" or "eh": both are standard. **Wrong stress to expect:** comFORTable, developMENT, ecoNOMy (for the noun), phoTOgraph, TECHnology, enviRONment. Note: *necessary* is NEcessary in American English; British speakers often say NE-cess-ry.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – CHUNKS AND ARROWS

A. (Suggested; accept other sensible chunking with one main stress per chunk.)

- 1 What I really enJOY about my job / is the vaRIety / because NO two days / are ever the SAME.
- 2 When I was YOUNGer / I HATed vegetables / but these DAYS / I actually grow my OWN.
- 3 PERsonally / I think public transporTATION / should be FREE / for STUdents and OLDer people.

B. 4 ↗ (yes/no question) · 5 ↘ (wh- question) · 6 bread ↗, milk ↗ and eggs ↘ (the list is finished) · 7 tea ↗ or coffee ↘ (a closed choice: one or the other). If the speaker means "any drink, for example tea or coffee?", a rise at the end is also possible; accept it if the learner can explain it.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – UPGRADE AND COLLOCATE

A. Models; many good versions exist.

- 1 My new job is genuinely rewarding, but the workload is pretty heavy. / ...but I have a heavy workload.
- 2 The park near my apartment is really pleasant, and there's a wide range of activities: tennis courts, a pond, even outdoor yoga.
- 3 The movie was pretty disappointing, and the ending was bizarre / baffling / completely unexpected.
- 4 Online learning has some real benefits, such as flexibility, but also a few drawbacks, like the lack of face-to-face contact.

Judge by precision, not size: *scenic* for a park is fine; *scenic* for a job is not. **Not yet:** "very very good," "extremely nice," or a "big word" in the wrong place ("The park is prestigious").

B. 5 balance · 6 workload · 7 attention · 8 knit · 9 daunting · 10 vividly · 11 make (British English also *take a decision*; accept it)

C. 12 N · 13 F (a *game-changer* is something that changes a whole situation, like a new technology; it doesn't describe a person's cooking) · 14 N · 15 F (two idioms forced together, and they contradict each other: *over the moon* = very happy, *under the weather* = slightly ill)

◆ EXERCISE 5 – PARAPHRASE AROUND A GAP (MODELS)

- 1 **receipt:** "It's the little piece of paper the store gives you after you pay, which shows what you bought and how much it cost."
- 2 **commute:** "It's the trip you make every day from your home to work or school and back again."
- 3 **landlord:** "It's the person who owns the apartment or house you live in and who you pay rent to."
- 4 **microwave:** "It's a kind of small oven in the kitchen that heats food really quickly, in a minute or two."

Any description a listener understands scores the point. The skill is to keep talking with a frame; perfection isn't the goal.

◆ DIALOGUE – AFTER THE RATING

Mina's evidence: Fluency: "You kept going for the whole two minutes and you used 'That said' really naturally." Lexical Resource: "You said 'nice' three times, but 'a heavy workload' was great." Pronunciation: "Clear, easy to follow... Your lists were a bit flat." (Grammatical Range & Accuracy isn't discussed: ask learners what she should have added.) She starts with the strongest criterion, gives a band with a quote each time, and ends with one target.

◆ SPEAKING – BAND-ESTIMATION TRIOS

No fixed answers. A good rating sheet has a **quote** (not an opinion) for each criterion, a whole band or "6/7" for each, and **one** concrete target. Peer bands are estimates; differences of one band between raters are normal. What matters is that the evidence matches the band card.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

What does the Pronunciation criterion reward?

A) Being clearly understood, with good use of stress, intonation and connected speech

B) A British or American native accent

C) Speaking as fast as possible

Why: the criterion is about intelligibility and control of pronunciation features. Accent isn't marked, and speed isn't the goal: fast, unclear speech lowers the score.

Q2

You can't remember a word. The best move for Lexical Resource?

A) Paraphrase: describe the word so the examiner understands

B) Stop and stay silent

C) Use a memorized idiom, even if it doesn't fit

Why: paraphrase shows flexible vocabulary and keeps you fluent. Silence costs twice (Fluency and Lexical Resource). A forced idiom that doesn't fit shows poor control of vocabulary.

Q3 · new

Which sentence uses idiomatic language naturally?

A) "My boss is a piece of cake, so the meeting was over the moon."

B) "The questions were raining cats and dogs in my exam."

C) "I used to find jazz a bit chaotic, but it's really grown on me."

Why: *it's grown on me* (= I like it more now than at first) is used with the right meaning in a natural context. A and B force idioms into places where they don't make sense.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (4.2)

Stress: comFORTable, developMENT, econOMy, PHOTography · flat lists with no final fall · every syllable equal (no chunks) · dropped -ed / -s endings in the long turn · "I am very interesting in..." (*interested*) · "an informations," "advices," "a good news" · forced idioms ("It's raining cats and dogs of problems") · very + extreme adjective ("very exhausted," "very fascinating") · "make a party / do a decision." For range, praise precise collocation (*a heavy workload, strike a balance*), a natural idiom used once, and a calm paraphrase frame.

4.3 · FULL PRACTICE & TEST-DAY STRATEGY (C14)

◆ MY TOOLKIT

No right answers. Look for honesty: a learner who rates every row "solid" may need a private conversation about their Practice Test 1 results. The "not yet" rows should appear in the learner's countdown plan.

◆ EXERCISE 1 – THE TEST-DAY BRIEFING (SCRIPT 4.3-A)

1	2	3	4	5	6
registered with	reporting time	clear (label-free)	locker	20 / twenty	40 / forty

Accept "used to register," "booked with" for 1; "transparent" for 3; "storage area" for 4.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – SPOT THE TEST-DAY ERROR

- 1 **Poor time management.** A hard question is worth one mark like any other: guess, mark it, move on, and come back only if there's time (about 20 minutes per passage).
- 2 **A memorized script.** Examiners recognize rehearsed speech, and it doesn't fit the card. Use the prep minute for keywords and talk naturally to the bullets.
- 3 **Letting one miss cascade.** The recording moves on. Let question 14 go, read ahead and re-anchor at the next question.
- 4 **Over-writing Task 1.** Task 2 is worth more and needs about 40 minutes. Aim for about 20 minutes and 150–200 words on Task 1 (overview + key features), then move on.
- 5 **Silence.** Ask: "Sorry, could you repeat that?" or "Could you put that another way?" In Part 3 the examiner can rephrase the question. Asking doesn't lower the score; silence does.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – ORDER THE COUNTDOWN

Week 1: (b) drill the weakest question type · **Week 2: (d)** get a Task 2 essay marked · **Week 3: (a)** full timed mock · **Week 4: (c)** light review only

Technique first, then feedback, then the full rehearsal, then taper and rest. Accept (d) in week 1 and (b) in week 2 if the learner argues that Writing is their weakest skill: the principle (build → apply → rehearse → taper) is what matters. (c) must be last and (a) must not be in week 4.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – DIAGNOSE THE PROFILE

1. **Karim:** average $(7.0 + 7.0 + 5.5 + 6.5) \div 4 = 6.5$, so the overall is met, but Writing 5.5 is below the 6.0 minimum. **No, he doesn't meet the requirement.** Focus on **Writing**: it breaks the rule on its own, it's his weakest skill, and lifting it to 6.0 both fixes the rule and nudges the average up. He shouldn't put extra hours into Listening or Reading.

2. **Lucía:** average $(7.0 + 7.0 + 6.5 + 6.5) \div 4 = 6.75 \rightarrow$ overall band **7.0** (.75 rounds up). **Yes, she meets it**, with every skill at 6.5 or above. **The risk:** there's no margin. If any one skill drops by half a band on the day, the average falls to 6.625 and the overall becomes 6.5; and Writing and Speaking are already at the minimum. She should lift **Writing or Speaking to 7.0** for a safety margin while keeping Listening and Reading ticking over.

Rounding rule to teach: the overall is rounded to the nearest half band; an average ending in .25 rounds up to .5, and one ending in .75 rounds up to the next whole band (6.25 → 6.5; 6.75 → 7.0; 6.125 → 6.0; 6.625 → 6.5).

◆ EXERCISE 5 – MY PLAN FOR THE DAY (MODELS)

A. Listening: read ahead in every pause, predict the answer type, never leave a blank, check spelling at the end. Reading: 20 minutes a passage, write on the answer sheet as I go, guess and move on. Writing: Task 1 in 20 minutes with an overview, then Task 2 for 40, keeping 3 minutes to check. Speaking: extend every answer, keywords in the prep minute, ask for repetition if needed.

B. If I miss a Listening answer, I'll move straight to the next question. · If a Reading question takes more than two minutes, I'll guess, mark it and come back later. · If my mind goes blank in Speaking, I'll say "Let me think for a second" and give an opinion and a reason. · If my hands are shaking, I'll breathe out slowly three times. · If I have 8 minutes left and no conclusion, I'll write a two-sentence conclusion immediately.

Check the form: *If* + present, *I'll* + verb. **Wrong:** "If I will miss...", "If I miss, I go to next."

◆ DIALOGUE – THE NIGHT BEFORE

If-then plans: "if you blank in Speaking? → Then I'll say..." and "if you miss an answer in Listening? → The recording moves on, so do I." Future plans: "I'm planning to arrive by 7:45"; "Just ten minutes on my toolkit notes" (a plan without a verb, fine in speech). Habits to copy: ID checked the night before, arriving early with a buffer, no cramming, a prepared filler, and a calm view of nerves.

◆ FULL SPEAKING MOCK AND COUNTDOWN PLAN

No fixed answers. **Mock:** the examiner's two bands should come with a quote each. **Countdown plan:** check that it has real **dates**, puts the weakest skill or question type in the early weeks, includes at least one full timed mock about two weeks out, names a **person** for Writing/Speaking feedback, and tapers in the last week. A plan with "study hard every day" and no dates is not yet a plan.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

On test morning, which item is essential?

A) A favorite pen

B) A bottle of water

C) The ID you registered with

Why: without the same ID document you used to register, you can't take the test. Pens or pencils and water are usually provided or allowed, but they aren't essential.

Q2

Which technique appears in both Reading and Speaking?

A) Skimming for gist

B) Paraphrasing

C) Trend language

Why: in Reading you recognize paraphrases of the question in the passage; in Speaking (and Writing) you produce them to show range and to talk around a gap. Skimming is a Reading skill; trend language is for Writing Task 1.

You believe your Writing score doesn't reflect your performance. What can you do?

A) Email the examiner.

B) Ask your test center for a remark (an "enquiry on results") within the allowed period.

C) Nothing.

Why: remarks go through the test center, within a limited period after the test. A fee is charged and refunded if the band score goes up. Candidates don't contact examiners.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (4.3)

"in the 14 of May" · "on 8:30" · "Tomorrow I study Reading" (for a plan) · "If I will miss..." · "I will have do two mocks" (*done*) · planning to study hard the night before · every row of the toolkit rated "solid" · countdown plans with no dates · confusing "overall" with "every skill" in score requirements · thinking the computer-delivered test is easier or that Speaking is done on a computer.

PRACTICE TEST 2 — BAND PROFILE & NEXT STEPS (C15–C16)

◆ GUIDANCE FOR THE WORKBOOK PAGE

- ◆ **Answers and bands:** Listening and Reading answers and the raw score → band table are in [assessment/practice-test-2-key.html](#). Speaking comes from your C16 speaking band slip; Writing follows after you mark the scripts.
- ◆ **Overall band:** the average of the four skills, rounded to the nearest half band (.25 → up to .5; .75 → up to the next whole band). Worked examples: $6.0 + 6.5 + 5.5 + 6.0 = 24 \div 4 = 6.0$ · $7.0 + 6.5 + 6.0 + 6.5 = 26 \div 4 = 6.5$ · $6.5 + 6.5 + 6.0 + 6.0 = 25 \div 4 = 6.25 \rightarrow 6.5$ · $7.0 + 7.0 + 6.5 + 6.5 = 27 \div 4 = 6.75 \rightarrow 7.0$. Until the Writing band arrives, learners can write an overall "estimate without Writing" or leave it blank.
- ◆ **"Where did my marks go?":** no fixed answers. The useful finding is a **starred row** (an error code or question type that appears in both practice tests). **T** (ran out of time / left a blank) in Reading usually points to the 20-minutes-per-passage plan (2.2, 4.3); **D** (distractor) in Listening points to the 2.1 strategy (the speaker corrects themselves); **F, K, Q** and **H** point to 2.3; **X** (transfer error) to the test-day technique in 4.3. The full code-to-lesson table is in [assessment/answer-keys.html](#).
- ◆ **Next-step plan:** check that the "one change" is specific (not "improve my English"), that the three weekly actions are things the learner can actually schedule, and that a person is named for Writing/Speaking feedback.
- ◆ **Expectations:** about half a band of improvement across eight weeks is common; Listening and Reading usually move first. A profile with no change is not a failure if the question-type analysis shows technique improving. Never compare learners' profiles.

